TEMPLETON BUILT

FREE GUIDE FOR ADELAIDE HOMEOWNERS

# The Adelaide cost benchmark.

Real cost ranges for extensions, renovations and custom homes — what sits inside each figure, and what almost every quote leaves out.

TEMPLETON BUILT · ADELAIDE
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# What's inside.

READ THIS FIRST

**A rate per square metre is a starting point, not a price.**

Every figure in this guide is a range, and every range is wide for a reason. Two houses of identical size on two Adelaide blocks can sit at opposite ends of the same range because of soil, access, fall, services and the condition of what is already there.

Use these numbers to work out whether your project is roughly viable. Do not use them to choose between builders.

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01

## How to read these ranges.

The figures below reflect general Adelaide market conditions for quality residential work. They assume a competent builder, licensed trades, compliant documentation and standard site conditions. They are not a quote and they are not specific to your property.

**Lower end of a range** generally means: flat site, straightforward access, simple roof form, standard glazing, modest wet-area count, and finishes selected for durability rather than statement.

**Upper end** generally means: sloping or constrained site, structural complexity, large-format or thermally broken glazing, multiple wet areas, bespoke joinery, and a specification chosen deliberately.

**Above the range** is normal for heritage-constrained sites, difficult access, significant structural remediation, or a specification driven by an architect's material palette. It is not a warning sign in itself.

02

## Extensions.

| PROJECT TYPE | TYPICAL RANGE | WHAT MOVES IT |
|---|---|---|
| Ground-floor rear addition | $2,500–$4,000 / m² | Site access, roof junction with existing, whether services can be extended or must be replaced |
| Second-storey addition | $3,000–$4,500+ / m² | Existing footings and structure, temporary weatherproofing, staircase location, whether you move out |
| Alfresco / covered outdoor | Varies widely | Whether it is genuinely a room (services, lighting, screening) or a roof over paving |

THE LINE MOST PEOPLE MISS

The junction between old and new is where extensions succeed or fail, both visually and financially. Matching floor levels, resolving the roofline and dealing with a wall that has moved for a century are rarely on a square-metre rate.

03

## Renovations.

| PROJECT TYPE | TYPICAL RANGE | WHAT MOVES IT |
|---|---|---|
| Internal renovation, single zone | $60,000–$200,000 | Whether walls are structural, whether wet areas move, joinery specification |
| Kitchen and scullery | Highly variable | Appliance package, stone selection, whether plumbing and electrical relocate |
| Whole-home renovation | Substantial | Rewiring, replumbing, re-roofing, damp treatment, underpinning — the invisible two-thirds |

OLDER ADELAIDE HOMES

**Structure first, finishes second.**

Rising damp, failed damp courses, inadequate footings, termite history and previous unpermitted work are common in Adelaide's stone housing stock. None of it is glamorous and all of it must be resolved before a finish is chosen. A renovation quote that goes straight to tiles and tapware has not looked hard enough.

04

## Custom homes.

Custom home costs vary too widely for a single useful range, because the site does so much of the deciding. What is consistent is the shape of the budget.

| COMPONENT | NOTES |
|---|---|
| Site works | Excavation, retaining, drainage, access, service connections. On a sloping or rural block this can be a significant share before a wall goes up. |
| Structure and shell | Footings, framing, roof, external cladding, windows. Largely set by form and span rather than finish. |
| Services | Hydraulic, electrical, heating and cooling. Driven by wet-area count and how far runs travel. |
| Fitout and joinery | Where specification has the most visible effect on the number, and the most room for you to steer it. |
| Rural or bushfire sites | Water storage, bushfire attack level requirements, access and power can add materially before design is considered. |

05

## What sits outside the build contract.

These are real project costs that usually do not appear in a builder's contract sum. Budget them separately or they will arrive as a surprise.

- ☐ Design, documentation and consultant fees
- ☐ Structural engineering and soil reports
- ☐ Energy efficiency assessment and certification
- ☐ Council and authority fees, planning and building consents
- ☐ Demolition and site clearing, where not in scope
- ☐ Driveways, paths, fencing and landscaping
- ☐ Window furnishings, loose furniture and appliances not in the schedule
- ☐ Temporary accommodation and storage if you move out
- ☐ Contingency of ten to fifteen per cent

06

## Where provisional sums hide.

A provisional sum is an allowance for work that cannot be priced exactly yet — usually because a selection has not been made, or because something is still hidden behind a wall. They are legitimate and unavoidable. They are also where budgets drift.

The problem is not that a quote contains provisional sums. It is that two quotes can contain very different allowances for the same work, which makes the headline figures meaningless to compare.

**ASK THIS**

For each provisional sum: what assumption is it based on, and what happens to the difference when the real invoice comes in? Under an open-book arrangement, the difference is reconciled and returned to you. Under others, it is not.

07

## Comparing two quotes that aren't comparable.

Two builders pricing the same drawings will rarely produce comparable documents. Before you compare the totals, compare these.

- ☐ Are both pricing the same documentation revision?
- ☐ What allowances does each carry for site works, and on what information?
- ☐ How many provisional sums are in each, and at what values?
- ☐ Is contingency included, excluded, or absent entirely?
- ☐ What is excluded — landscaping, driveways, window furnishings, connections?
- ☐ What is the builder's margin, and can you see it?
- ☐ What is the programme, and what happens to cost if it extends?
- ☐ Who carries the risk if something unexpected is found in the existing structure?

THE LINE THAT MATTERS

**If you cannot see the margin, you cannot check the rest.**

Every other line in a costing schedule can be verified against a quote or a rate. The builder's margin is the only one that is purely a decision. When it is shown plainly, you stop wondering whether it has been distributed quietly across the trades. When it is not shown, you never entirely stop wondering.

NEXT STEP

# If the numbers in this guide made you want a second opinion, that's the point.

We price every project open-book: you receive the full costing schedule, every trade, every allowance and our margin written plainly at the bottom. It is the fastest way to find out whether what you want and what you have are the same size.

A first conversation costs nothing. Bring a survey, a sketch, or just the address.

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TALK TO JORDAN OR PAUL


## 1800 955 111

## hello@templetonbuilt.com.au

12 Stirling Street, Thebarton SA 5033
templetonbuilt.com.au


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TEMPLETON BUILT PTY LTD · ABN 16 067 209 161 · LICENCE BLD183145



This guide is general information for Adelaide homeowners planning a project. It is not a quote, a cost estimate for your specific property, or professional advice on your site. Figures reflect general market conditions at time of writing and will change.